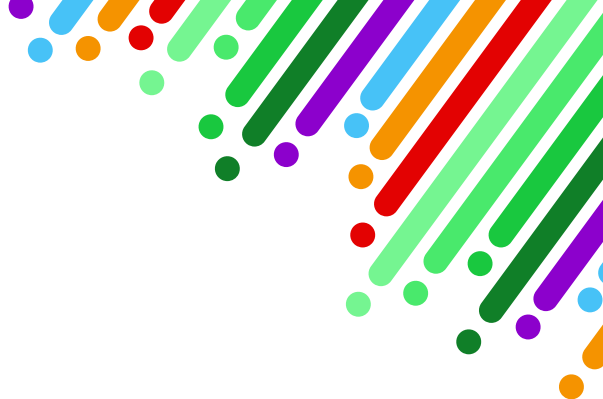




Nevada Pre-Kindergarten Standards, Revised 2023

**Building a Foundation for School
Readiness and Success in
PreK-12 and Beyond**



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Social Studies

Social Studies highlights the knowledge children gain about the people and places in their world through their experiences. Young children begin learning about social studies content as they learn about their family and their community, and also as they learn about themselves and their roles within the community. As they gain knowledge of the people, places, and roles within their community, they develop awareness of similarities and differences between people they meet, laying the foundation for their understanding of and appreciation for cultural differences within their community. Children also have the opportunity to notice how persons from different groups speak different languages, a key feature of the cultures that they learn about through their direct experiences—through their interactions with their own family, classroom, and places they go regularly.

Children begin to learn about how their communities work through classroom experiences as they learn about roles, rights, and responsibilities. For example, they learn clean-up routines and their responsibility to put away their toys. Gradually they expand their knowledge of the world and come to understand important concepts included in the Social Studies Standards. The National Council for the Social Studies (2019) position statement *Early Childhood in the Social Studies Context* provides an overview of how teachers can create learning experiences and classroom environments to support the integration of social studies themes into play-based learning for children. The Social Studies Standards use play-based instruction to integrate all other content areas into how children learn about the people, places, and roles that are important in their world. Many of the practices that teachers use to support children in this domain also support children's progress in other domains. These cross-curricular supportive practices are indicated with an asterisk (*) in the charts below.

The Social Studies Standards include:

- **Social Studies Standard 1:**

Demonstrate a basic awareness of self as an individual, within the context of a group and community.

- **Social Studies Standard 2:**

Demonstrate a basic understanding of roles, rights, and responsibilities in their classroom and home.

- **Social Studies Standard 3:**

Demonstrate knowledge of the relationship between people and places.

- **Social Studies Standard 4:**

Demonstrate the ability to differentiate between the concepts of past, present, and future, and recognize that people and things change over time.

- **Social Studies Standard 5:**

Demonstrate an awareness of basic economic concepts.



Social Studies Standard 1:

Demonstrate a basic awareness of self as an individual, within the context of a group and community.

Individual Development and Cultural Identity Indicators (SS.ID)	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
SS.ID.PK1. Identify and describe characteristics of self that are unique from others.	Repeat their full name and age. Discuss their own likes/dislikes. Recognize and name the language(s) they speak.	• Encourage children to describe themselves based on various characteristics (e.g., physical features, age, classroom group).* • Use books/literature to lead discussions on differences between people, different family traditions, celebrations, and rituals, and illustrate different cultures.*
SS.ID.PK2. Identify self as a member of a family.	Describe their own family structure (e.g., who is part of their family and how they are related). Draw pictures of their family or label family members when looking at a photo, including self. Describe their own role and the role of others in their own family.	• Provide opportunities for children to discuss likes and dislikes.* • Make multicultural dolls/books/materials available and use them during various lessons. Materials should represent differing languages, ethnicities, cultures, ages, abilities, and genders.* • Make connections between children's home language(s) and English with multilingual learners.*
SS.ID.PK3. Share information about their family practices, customs, and culture.	Show how their own family typically does routines (e.g., greeting each other, eating together). Describe their own family's holiday traditions/celebrations and food. Bring items from home (e.g., clothing, pictures, props) to share with their group as they explain customs from their family.	• Use books/literature to lead discussions on families and different family structures, including cross-cultural living arrangements and shared housing.* • Provide opportunities for children to share information about their family.* • Invite families to talk about their cultures and traditions. • Provide opportunities and planned activities for children to share events, routines, traditions, and rituals. • Discuss and share their own routines and weekend plans/events with children.
SS.ID.PK4. Identify and describe family traditions and daily rituals that are important to their family.	Describe morning, after school, and weekend routines. Describe places their family goes together and what they do (e.g., homes of extended family members, stores, places of worship).	• Include props or artifacts that reflect the customs of children in the group within dramatic play areas so that children can incorporate their own family's traditions into their dramatic play.* • Join children's dramatic play and encourage them to talk about or act out how their family does simple routines (e.g., caring for a baby, shopping, or cleaning their house).*

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.

Social Studies Standard 2:

Demonstrate a basic understanding of roles, rights, and responsibilities in their classroom and home.

Civic Ideas and Practices Indicators (SS.CI)	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
SS.CI.PK1. Identify self as member of a classroom or community.	Help during classroom routines (e.g., clean-up time, water classroom plants, pass out utensils and napkins during meal/snack). Participate in community events (e.g., parades, festivals, fairs). Identify their classroom or school, when asked (e.g., say the name of their school, indicate who is their teacher).	• Provide opportunities for classroom jobs and rotate among all children. • Teach children responsibilities such as cleaning up their toys and throwing away their trash. • Discuss modifications and adaptations that children with disabilities may need to participate in classroom activities and teach children how to include peers with disabilities in classroom activities.*
SS.CI.PK2. Identify classroom teachers/practitioners and peers by name.	Identify children in their class. Recognize and associate a peer by the letters or symbols they use as their signature. Refer to peers and teachers/practitioners by the name they are called in their classroom.	• Discuss community events and places children go with their families, helping children see connections between community events/places they and their peers describe.* • Provide multiple opportunities for children to write their name (e.g., sign in at beginning of the day, sign work that is completed, sign cards).* • Make connections to children's name writing as their signature.*
SS.CI.PK3. Recognize and resolve conflicts with peers in an age-appropriate manner.	Ask a teacher/practitioner for assistance during a conflict. Tell a peer that they will share a toy when they are finished with it.	• Sing songs and chants that include the names of children in the group.*
SS.CI.PK4. Show awareness of and follow group routines and rules.	Put away backpack and coat when first entering the classroom. Choose a place to sit at the table when the teacher reminds them that it is snack time. Show where group routines or rules are on display within the classroom.	• Teach and use strategies to resolve conflicts.* • Create and use classroom management skills to reduce conflicts.* • Use books/literature and social stories to lead discussions on conflict resolution.*
SS.CI.PK5. Participate in group decision-making.	Express preference between a choice of activities the group is considering. Raise hand or use tally marks to vote on a group decision.	• Lead class discussions about what routines and rules to have in the classroom, why they are important, and how they compare with those of our homes or communities.* • Post classroom and learning area rules and review them frequently. Remind children of the rules and why they exist.*

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.

Social Studies Standard 2:

Demonstrate a basic understanding of roles, rights, and responsibilities in their classroom and home.

Civic Ideas and Practices Indicators (SS.CI)	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
SS.CI.PK6. Work together to complete simple tasks with peers.	Work with peers to clean up learning centers. Work with a peer to complete a puzzle.	• Use a picture schedule to show classroom routines. Review routines frequently; some children may need individual schedules and more frequent reminders.* • Provide frequent opportunities to allow for group decisions.
SS.CI.PK7. Identify and describe the roles of different community helpers.	Pretend to be a community worker. Identify the role of community workers by the uniform worn or equipment used. Describe the various jobs or activities community workers perform.	• Provide frequent opportunities for children to work together collaboratively.* • Provide costumes and props to represent a variety of community helpers in dramatic play.* • Use books/literature to lead discussions on community helpers.*

Social Studies Standard 3:

Demonstrate knowledge of the relationship between people and places.

Geography, Humans, and the Environment Indicators (SS.GH)	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
SS.GH.PK1. Use spatial words to identify direction and location.	Accurately use words such as up/down, above/below, over/under, here/there, inside/outside, and left/right. Accurately follow directions that include spatial words.	• Use songs, fingerplays, and games that encourage following spatial directions.* • Play games, such as I Spy or I Am Thinking of a Place, to describe things or places in the classroom and community, including cultural variations of these games relevant to children's culture.
SS.GH.PK2. Identify and describe their classroom, home, or community.	Describe characteristics of familiar places. During play, demonstrate or talk about characteristics of their own home or community as they pretend and role play. Build a familiar street with blocks and describe points of interest they created.	• Provide opportunities and activities that encourage children to talk, draw, and write about their home or favorite places.* • Include props in the block area that encourage children to build and talk about models of their home and other landmarks in their community. Include toy vehicles and encourage children to use words to describe positions and directions as they move their vehicles.*

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.

Science

The Science domain is the “S” in STEAM (Science, Technology, Engineering, the Arts, and Mathematics) and the starting point for the STEAM section of the standards. Developmentally appropriate early childhood STEAM experiences guide and engage young children in their natural curiosity to critically explore and ask questions about the world around them. Teachers/practitioners can intentionally build on children’s interests in teaching the STEAM concepts of reasoning and inquiry (National Science Teachers Association [NSTA], 2014). Children’s STEAM proficiency is developed over time as they engage in STEAM explorations that meet multiple learning standards, through a combination of their own investigations and teacher/practitioner guidance along the way. Teachers can set the stage for STEAM by setting up the environment with a wide array of open-ended materials that can be used for construction; by providing creative engineering problems for children to solve; and by asking open-ended questions as children hypothesize, design, experiment, analyze, report, and try again (Linder & Eckhoff, 2020).



Preschool children are natural scientists, filled with curiosity about the world and how it works (Larimore, 2020). They learn science concepts and refine their skills in observation and inquiry by doing science through active play and exploration of their environment. Teachers can deepen children’s interest and build children’s skills and knowledge in this area by supporting, extending, and providing vocabulary for the cycle of inquiry. Practicing the scientific process in prekindergarten by asking questions, making predictions, gathering data, analyzing outcomes, and drawing conclusions capitalizes and builds on children’s natural curiosity and gives them the vocabulary and experiences that will prepare them for success in kindergarten and beyond (NSTA, 2014). Teachers can model the scientific questions and observations by wondering or noticing things aloud as they pose questions or state observations to embed language into explorations. This practice builds children’s oral language and encourages them to also wonder aloud as they formulate their own thoughts and begin wondering or noticing. Teachers can use multilingual approaches to bring science to life in children’s home languages and support cross-linguistic connections that facilitate meaning-making for all young children.

NAEYC's *10 Tips to Support Children's Science Learning* (Lan, n.d.) offers guidance on how teachers can create learning experiences and classroom environments to support science exploration by giving children time and space to explore, find answers to questions together, learn from mistakes, and even make a little mess sometimes. Teachers can also apply the Science Standards in other content areas and domains, giving children the opportunity to observe and discover as they learn other skills. Science concepts can be taught and integrated within other learning and developmental domains. For example, an integrated literacy activity can include reading a fictional book together, then identifying a challenge or problem the characters experienced in the story and challenging children to creatively solve the problem from the story by applying STEAM concepts. Many of the practices that teachers use to support children in this domain also support children's progress in other domains. These cross-curricular supportive practices are indicated with an asterisk (*) in the charts below.



The Science Standards include:

- **Science Standard 1:**

Demonstrate the ability to use senses and tools to explore, make observations, and make predictions.

- **Science Standard 2:**

Demonstrate the ability to use information gathered in different ways to conduct investigations.

- **Science Standard 3:**

Demonstrate the ability to describe, analyze, and draw conclusions about the outcome of an investigation.

- **Science Standard 4:**

Demonstrate the ability to communicate about observations, investigations, and outcomes.

Science Standard 1:

Demonstrate the ability to use senses and tools to explore, make observations, and make predictions.

Exploration, Observation, and Hypotheses Indicators (S.EO)	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
S.EO.PK1. Use smell, touch, sight, sound, and taste to make observations.	Explore characteristics of nature using the five senses. Hold new or unfamiliar objects to learn more about them. Listen for sounds that give clues about the characteristics of objects, living creatures, and processes (e.g., listen to air being let out of a balloon, listen to paper being crumpled up).	• Provide opportunities for children to explore the natural world using all five senses.* • Provide a variety of tools (e.g., magnifying glasses, rulers, scales, tweezers, cameras, tape recorders) to support investigation and observation. Provide adaptive tools for children with disabilities. • Teach children how to use tools and how to record observations.* • Encourage children to share their thoughts and ideas about their observations.*
S.EO.PK2. Use tools to observe and describe objects, the environment, and processes.	Use magnifying glasses, rulers, scales, binoculars, telescopes, or tweezers to observe objects. Take pictures of the classroom environment with a digital camera and describe features of the room they see in the pictures. With teacher support, use tools to record and describe processes (e.g., a thermometer to measure the temperature of cold or warm water and ice that is melting, a ruler to measure plants growing).	• Provide children with opportunities to sort based on observations they make during classroom experiences. Talk about the categories used to sort objects and how to decide what goes into each of the respective groups.* • Point out and talk about processes that happen in the classroom (e.g., plants growing, bread left out getting hard, ice melting).* • Ask children questions to help them make predictions based on their observations (e.g., “What do you think will happen if ...?” “How do you think these will go together?” “Which do you think will be fastest/loudest/heaviest?”).*
S.EO.PK3. Use observations and information to notice patterns, create groups based on similarities/differences observed, and/or make predictions.	Use magnets to group together objects that are attracted to the magnets. Put objects in water and see which ones float and which ones sink. Sort the objects that float together into a group. Drop objects of varying weights from varying heights to see what is different about how they fall.	• Encourage children to record observations of the weather, trees, and other plants on the playground over an extended period of time and talk about the changes that happen.* • Read books about topics related to science (e.g., nature, weather, tools) and talk about related objects and processes they observe in the classroom (e.g., read a book about fish and provide a goldfish in a fishbowl for the children to observe).*

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.

Science Standard 1:

Demonstrate the ability to use senses and tools to explore, make observations, and make predictions.

Exploration, Observation, and Hypotheses Indicators (S.EO)	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
S.EO.PK4. Make predictions using prior knowledge and experience.	Make predictions about weather. Decide if the class can go outside, making a prediction based on knowledge of the weather from the day before. Refer to something they heard read in a book to make predictions about what will happen (e.g., predict that bread they are baking will rise based on having heard a teacher read a book about how a bakery makes bread).	• Read fiction and nonfiction books to inspire investigation and problem-solving (e.g., read a book about insects and make observations of insects on the playground, read a book that shows children using magnets with different objects and then give children magnets to try with different objects in the classroom, read a book that includes animals sounds and invite children to produce these sounds with their own voices or other classroom objects).* • Encourage vocabulary to describe how fast or slow objects fall and discuss why.* • Encourage children to make predictions about their environment, weather, seasons, or temperature.

Science Standard 2:

Demonstrate the ability to use information gathered in different ways to conduct investigations.

Scientific Investigation Indicators (S.SI)	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
S.SI.PK1. Show curiosity and ask questions about things they are interested in that can be answered through an investigation.	Ask questions about why things happen. Call attention to something they have observed and point out what they find interesting.	• Provide opportunities for children to experiment with different materials. Talk about what happens when they make changes or act on the materials in different ways (e.g., what happens when they roll balls down slopes of different heights/angles, what happens when they use different objects in front of a light to make shadows).*
S.SI.PK2. Describe some of the steps and/or materials needed for an investigation or experiment.	Gather materials that are needed to investigate something in which they are interested. Make binoculars with their fists and hold up to their eyes to explain they need to get a closer look at birds during a nature walk.	• Provide opportunities for children to experiment with water in different forms. • Use picture charts to illustrate the steps in an investigation. Refer to the picture chart when conducting an investigation so children can follow along.*

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.

Technology

Technology represents the “T” in STEAM and is the second domain of the STEAM section of the prekindergarten standards. Although children engage in STEAM disciplines through their everyday play, the foundational principles of STEAM cannot be met without knowledgeable teachers and practitioners explicitly engaging children in technology exploration during the preschool years. Preschoolers with a developing understanding of technology benefit from enhanced cognitive and social skills as they explore, play make-believe, create their own technology tools, actively engage in challenging activities, and more (U.S. Department of Education [ED] & U.S. Department of Health and Human Services [HHS], 2016). Teachers should use developmentally appropriate practices and principles to intentionally integrate technology and content domains into daily activities for young children.



This new Technology domain was added to the Nevada Pre-Kindergarten Standards in 2023. Digital literacy and citizenship are necessary skills for prekindergarten children to learn in today’s increasingly technology-centered world. When using technology, children develop a variety of skills including creative thinking, problem-solving, fine motor, literacy, and number sense. They also learn to use technology safely and responsibly by engaging in appropriate activities with guidance. Teachers are not presumed to be experts to implement technology activities right away in their classrooms. The National Association for the Education of Young Children (NAEYC) and the Fred Rogers Center for Early Learning and Children’s Media at Saint Vincent College (2012) published a position statement endorsing the use of digital technology for young children, stating:

Technology and interactive media are tools that can promote effective learning and development when they are used intentionally by early childhood educators, within the framework of developmentally appropriate practice, to support learning goals established for individual children. (p. 5)

Interactive media and digital technology can have many benefits when used as age-appropriate learning tools that are intentionally integrated into playful activities to increase access to information (ED & HHS, 2016). Utilizing simple applications can help children develop the necessary digital literacy skills to help them to become digital citizens.

NAEYC and the Fred Rogers Center (2012) also offer several guidelines for successfully using digital tools with preschoolers:

- Teachers should be intentional about incorporating technology into any lesson plan.
- Electronic devices must be used in a way that promotes active, hands-on learning experiences.
- Lesson plans should emphasize co-viewing or co-usage alongside teachers and peers.
- Teachers must take the time to observe children’s use of technology to identify potential problems, evaluate learning outcomes, and adapt accordingly.

These standards define technology broadly as the creation and use of tools to meet a purpose, and not simply limited to digital, screen-based devices. Furthermore, this domain does not require children's individual use of digital devices, and standards can be met without using screen time at all. When screen-based devices are used in the classroom, teachers need to carefully consider current research and recommendations for children's active versus passive digital use, screen-time limits for young children, and other guidance as technology evolves. Technology tools, like all other classroom materials, must support learning and not be used as an isolated activity. Thus, many of the practices that teachers use to support children in this domain also support children's progress in other domains. These cross-curricular supportive practices are indicated with an asterisk (*) in the charts below.

In this context, the new Technology Standards explore digital technology, nondigital technology, and assistive technology. Unless otherwise specified in the standard or indicator, the term "technology" can be adapted to fit any of these three types of technology:

1. Digital technology includes but is not limited to cameras, speakers, computers, tablets, keyboard and mouse, projector screens, smartboards, smartphones, etc.
2. Nondigital technology includes but is not limited to make-believe or symbolic representations of a digital device, writing tools, books, other objects created by adults or children to help solve a problem, etc.
3. Assistive technology includes but is not limited to glasses, hearing aids, prosthetic limbs, screen readers, voice recognition, walking canes, wheelchairs, etc.



The Technology Standards include:

- **Technology Standard 1:**

Demonstrate knowledge that different types of technology tools have different uses, including digital, nondigital, and assistive technology.

- **Technology Standard 2:**

Use technology for communication and to gather and share information.

- **Technology Standard 3:**

Demonstrate safe and responsible use of technology and resources.

Technology Standard 1:

Demonstrate knowledge that different types of technology tools have different uses, including digital, nondigital, and assistive technology.

Technology as a Tool Indicators (T.TT)	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
T.TT.PK1. Identify a variety of digital technology tools and their uses.	Name digital technology tools used in the classroom and/or at home (e.g., smartphones, tablets, computers). Pretend to type on a keyboard to send a message during dramatic play. Select a digital story book to read or to be read. Dictate a story to be typed into a computer or tablet.	• Identify the names of digital technology tools as they are used in the classroom (by a teacher and/or other children). • Invite families to explore digital technology tools with children on special family technology evenings. • Discuss with children the symbols used in different digital technology platforms and what they mean. • Ask children to locate the headphones so they can listen to a story online.*
T.TT.PK2. Identify a variety of nondigital technology tools and their uses.	Combine a row of blocks to serve as a ramp for cars and trucks in the block area. Invent and construct simple objects into more complex structures. Measure objects with rulers and write down the length or height. Engage in hands-on creative activities and other analog activities that are nondigital. Draw a picture using a stick in the dirt.	• Notice and comment on children's discussions about experiences with digital technology tools at home. • Notice and comment on children's use of pretend digital technology tools throughout the day. • Use e-books or other digital technology tools with children during story time.* • Point out nondigital technology tools throughout the classroom and outdoor environment and note the purpose or use of each. • Provide access to devices and applications that encourage creativity and allow children to express themselves. • Provide a variety of tools for writing, drawing, and painting.*
T.TT.PK3. Identify a variety of assistive technology tools and their uses.	Identify self, peers, family members, and/or teachers who use glasses to help them see. Notice the illustration of a child using a wheelchair during story time. Describe assistive technology they have noticed in the community (e.g., a person walking with a cane or wearing hearing aids).	• Provide materials (e.g., books, illustrations, figures) depicting a range of physical abilities and assistive technologies in use. • Ask questions to extend children's engagement with materials depicting varying physical abilities.

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.

Technology Standard 1:

Demonstrate knowledge that different types of technology tools have different uses, including digital, nondigital, and assistive technology.

Technology as a Tool Indicators (T.TT)	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
		• Read stories featuring characters with a range of physical abilities and using a variety of assistive devices. Ask children questions to connect the stories to their own experiences.* • Discuss and demonstrate the use of braille type and a screen reader. • Discuss and demonstrate screen settings that can be altered to accommodate visual impairments. • Include interactive picture visuals to support nonverbal communication between children and adults or peers.* • Use nondigital teaching-learning resources like books, whiteboards charts, maps, models, etc. while teaching concepts to children.* • Introduce vocabulary words that include “digital” and “analog”.* • Provide opportunities for children to use different forms of assistive technology. • Lead discussions that encourage children to solve real-life challenges and identify assistive tools that could help.*

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.

Technology Standard 2:

Use technology for communication and to gather and share information.

Communicating Through Technology Indicators (T.CT)	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
T.CT.PK1. Use technology to communicate information, with teacher assistance.	Record a voice message or memo for a family member or loved one. Create a digital drawing. Help select letters on the keyboard to send a message. Dictate a message for a teacher to write to a family member or peer. Type a text message for a peer on a pretend smartphone. Draw a picture to communicate a message or idea.	• Show pictures and video of environments, spaces, and places that children would not be able to physically visit in order to broaden knowledge and connections to a concept or unit theme. • Provide interactive and open-ended computer programs for children to use. • Document children's drawings and create digital books with photos to explore digital storytelling. • Use apps and games that focus on specific standards-based skills. • Use apps and computer programs that promote curiosity and wonder and do not emphasize repetitive drills or practices. • Provide access to digital tools with audio, video, and graphics to create or communicate ideas with their peers.
T.CT.PK2. Use technology to explore and answer questions about the world, with teacher assistance.	Use a real or pretend camera to document and gather information during a photo hunt. Use voice technology to conduct an internet search. Use images online to learn about a new animal/habitat. Visit a virtual zoo, museum, aquarium, or other location.	• Encourage children to explore other cultures by using digital tools or by bringing artifacts in for children to make connections to their own culture or one they have learned about.* • Discuss and model for children when and how to obtain information through technology. • Provide a variety of age-appropriate programs to support children learning how to manipulate the mouse and keyboard to access information.

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.